Neo-Brutalism Theme

Version 1.0 ·

Complete design reference for the Neo-Brutalism (BrandEx) theme. Use these specs for all future components, pages, and UI additions.

1. COLOR PALETTE

All colors are CSS custom properties on .theme-neobrutalism. Use exact hex codes only — no approximations.

Color Name	Hex Code	CSS Variable	Usage / Where Applied
Near-Black	#0C0C0C	--bg2 / --border / --black	Navbar, all borders, box-shadows, text on cream
Warm Cream	#F0E8D0	--bg / --panel-hover	Main page background, light section fills
Deep Cream	#E8DFC7	--bg-alt	Alternate section bg, table alternate rows
Off-White	#232323	--panel	Card surfaces, inputs, modal backgrounds
Burnt Orange	#C94A00	--accent / --accent-primary	CTA buttons, active nav, borders, primary actions
Dark Teal	#0A6B52	--accent4 / --teal	Section backgrounds, success states, status dot
Bright Teal	#0D9970	--accent2 / --teal-lt	Links, focus rings, logo, hover highlights
Bold Yellow	#D4A800	--accent3 / --yellow	Warnings, stamp labels, highlighted text

2. TYPOGRAPHY

Role	Font Family	Weight / Style	Where Used
Display / Headings	Bebas Neue	400 (display weight)	Hero H1, stat numbers, CTA headline, stamp labels
Body Text	Space Grotesk	400 / 500 / 700	All body copy, descriptions, nav links, paragraphs
Labels / Code	DM Mono	500 (medium)	Badges, section tags, clock, uppercase monospace labels
System Fallback	Arial Black / Arial	Bold	Used when Google Fonts unavailable — fully readable fallback

3. BORDERS & SHADOWS

CSS Variable	Value	Effect / When Used
--border-thin	2px solid #0C0C0C	Subtle dividers, inside table borders, nav link separators
--border-thick	3px solid #0C0C0C	Panels, cards, buttons, section borders
--radius	0px (hard corners)	Core rule — NO rounding. 6px max for buttons/cards only.
--shadow	5px 5px 0 #0C0C0C	Standard card/panel hard offset shadow (no blur)
--shadow-sm	3px 3px 0 #0C0C0C	Small elements — tags, badges, small buttons
--shadow-lg	8px 8px 0 #0C0C0C	Hero elements, prominent featured cards
--shadow-accent	5px 5px 0 #C94A00	Active/selected panels — orange shadow variant
Hover state	translate(-3px, -3px)	Element lifts up-left. Shadow grows to 8px 8px 0
Press / Active	translate(+3px, +3px)	Element presses down-right. Shadow collapses to 0.

4. STATUS BADGE COLORS

All badges: 2px solid border, uppercase font, monospace, background is ~12% opacity tint of border color.

Badge	Border Color	Text Color	Used For Status
Draft	rgba(12,12,12,0.40)	#555555 (dim)	Not started — default placeholder state
Complete	#0D9970 (Bright Teal)	#0A6B52	Story writing finished, awaiting review
Review	#C94A00 (Orange)	#C94A00	Submitted for approval — pending decision
Approved	#0A6B52 (Dark Teal)	#0A6B52	Green-lit, cleared for publishing queue
Scheduled	#D4A800 (Yellow)	#8a6800 (dark)	Queued with a future publish date/time
Published	#8B2FC9 (Purple)	#8B2FC9	Live on YouTube — cannot be recalled

5. COMPONENT RULES

Buttons

- bg: #C94A00 (primary) / #FAF6EE off-white (secondary)
- border: 2.5px solid #0C0C0C on all sides — always visible
- border-radius: 6px — slight only, not pill-shaped
- box-shadow: 5px 5px 0 #0C0C0C (hard, no blur)
- Hover: translate(-2px,-2px) + shadow grows to 7px 7px
- Click: translate(+3px,+3px) + shadow collapses to 0
- Font: DM Mono, UPPERCASE, letter-spacing: 0.5px

Cards / Panels

- background: #FAF6EE (off-white)
- border: 3px solid #0C0C0C
- border-radius: 6px
- box-shadow: 5px 5px 0 #0C0C0C

- Hover: translate(-3px,-3px), shadow grows to 8px 8px 0 #0C0C0C
- NEVER use gradients or transparency inside cards

Inputs / Forms

- background: #FAF6EE
- border: 2px solid #0C0C0C (2.5px on focus)
- border-radius: 0px — hard corners on ALL form inputs
- Focus: border-color → #C94A00 + box-shadow: 0 0 0 2px rgba(201,74,0,0.20)
- Placeholder: rgba(12,12,12,0.35)

Tabs / Navigation

- Tab bar bg: #F0E8D0 (cream), border-bottom: 3px solid #0C0C0C
- Inactive: color rgba(12,12,12,0.55), right-border: 1.5px solid #ddd4ba
- Active: color #0C0C0C, border-bottom: 4px solid #C94A00 (orange underline)
- Hover: background #E8DFC7 (deep cream)

Navbar / Header

- background: ALWAYS #0C0C0C (dark) — never changes with theme
- Logo: BRIGHT in #FAF6EE, . in #C94A00, STORIES in #0D9970
- Nav links: #888 inactive → #FFF hover → #C94A00 bg active
- position: sticky, top: 0, z-index: 100, height: 58px

Stamps / Decorative

- Font: Bebas Neue, size 20-24px, letter-spacing: 2px
- border: 3px solid #0C0C0C, border-radius: 6px
- Rotation: -9deg / +5deg / -4deg for visual energy
- Yellow: bg #D4A800, text #0C0C0C (dark for contrast)
- Teal: bg #0D9970, text #FFFFFF
- Orange: bg #C94A00, text #FFFFFF

6. NEO-BRUTALISM GOLDEN RULES

- ZERO gradients — flat solid fills only. No linear-gradient or radial-gradient anywhere.
- ZERO blur in shadows — always "5px 5px 0 #0C0C0C" not "5px 5px 8px rgba(...)".
- ZERO glassmorphism — no backdrop-filter, no frosted/glass effects.
- ZERO floating elements — everything has a visible border. Nothing appears without an outline.
- Hard corners default — 0px border-radius on inputs. 6px max on buttons and cards.
- Shadow direction: always bottom-right (positive X, positive Y offset).
- Hover = LIFT — translate(-x, -y), shadow grows. Element moves toward viewer.
- Click = PRESS — translate(+x, +y), shadow shrinks to 0. Element presses down.
- ALL caps for labels and badges — letter-spacing 0.5px to 2px depending on element size.
- Dark navbar is PERMANENT — never changes color regardless of selected theme.